

more at 9 seconds. Epson lost out hugely here, taking a cool 20 seconds to get warmed up.

Though the Epson took 20 whole seconds to charge itself up, it redeemed itself in our speed tests—completely decimating the competition.

Clocking just 9.42 seconds to print the text page in normal mode and 9.5 seconds in best mode. This isn't even comparable to the second-best times of 14.91 seconds by Brother and 15.25 seconds by Samsung for normal mode.

Canon did surprisingly badly and came in last with a time of 20.17 seconds.

The Epson needed only 19.5 seconds to spit out our combi-document in Normal mode, and 20.74 seconds in Best modes. Samsung came in second with 26.2 and 37.9 seconds respectively, and surprisingly, Canon beat it in the High Quality test by a cool 5 seconds—just 32.7 seconds in best mode.



Scoreboard - Colour Laser Printers AUGUST 2005				
BRAND	Canon	Epson	Brother	Samsung
Model	LBP 5200	AcuLaser C1100	HL-2700CN	CLP-500
Features	17.10	25.29	26.02	24.85
Printing				
Printing technology	Laser	Laser	Laser	Laser
Resolution (dpi x dpi)	600x600	600x600	600x600	600x600
Paper capacity for Default tray	125	180	250	250
Additional paper tray facility	✗	✓	✓	✓
Dual Side Printing	✓	✓	✗	✓
Accessories				
Data cable	✗	✓	✓	✓
Power cord	✓	✓	✓	✓
Detailed User Manual	✓	✓	✗	✓
Troubleshooting guide	✗	✗	✓	✓
Quick setup guide	✓	✗	✓	✓
Bundled Software	✗	✗	✗	✗
Misc features				
Printing Language Supported	CAPT	ESC	PCL6/PS3	SPL
OS Support	Windows	Win/Mac	Win/Mac	Win/Linux
LCD Screen(Color/B/W)	✗	✓/B/W	✓/B/W	✓/B/W
Interface (USB 1.1/2.0/Parallel)	USB 2.0/Parallel	USB 2.0/Parallel	USB 2.0/Parallel	USB 2.0/Parallel
Menu structure				
Ease of use (scale of 5)	No Screen	3	2.5	3.75
Toner Duty Cycle(Bundled)	2000	1500	10,000	2000
Toner Duty Cycle(New)	5000	1500	10,000	7000
Networking capabilities (Y/N/Optional)	Optional	✓	✓	Optional
Build Quality				
Breakable flaps/moveable (Out of 5)	4.25	4	4.25	4
Transport locks/tapes (Out of 5)	3	3.5	4.5	4
Moveable parts in cartridge bay parts (Out of 5)	4	4	4	4
Performance	20.91	24.58	13.62	18.02
Speed test (Secs)				
Warm Up Time	4	20.19	9	8
Text print (B/W) Normal/Best	20.17 / 20.59	9.42 / 9.5	14.91 / 17.75	15.25 / 18.75
Combi document - Normal/Best	30.16 / 32.7	19.51 / 20.74	160.49 / 165.61	26.21 / 37.9
Photo Printout (Best)	37.01	24.87	102.36	52.79
Quality Test				
Text quality (Point Size Document Out of 5)	3.25	3.25	4	3.75
Image quality (Combi, Normal) (Out of 55)	41.5	36.5	30.25	33.25
Image quality (Combi, Best) (Out of 55)	41.5	42	30.5	31.5
Photo Quality (Best) (Out of 35)	22.25	24.5	14.75	21
Warranty Details	6.63	6.10	4.69	7.89
Number of Years	2	1	1	3
Type (onsite/Carry In)	Onsite	Onsite	Onsite	Onsite
Number of Authorised Service Centres	130	211	105	165
Price	15.19	12.91	12.96	12.36
Price of Printer (Rs)	34995	37500	45900	45990
Price of Black Toner (Rs)	5495	4675	8200	6999
Price of Color Toner	6495 x 3	6675 x 3	8200 x 3	7999 x 3
Rated Cost Per Page (B/W A4 Size)	1.099	3.12	0.82	0.999857143
Overall Score (Out of 100)	59.82	68.87	57.30	63.12

So, basically, if you need to print out lots of reports, company charts and presentations, the Epson will get the job done faster.

Since these were colour printers, we decided to put them through a photo quality print test as well. It was only fair to check this out.

Epson did not disappoint us and gave us a crisp, clear printout in under 25 seconds. The Canon took 37 seconds and came in a respectable second. The Samsung and Brother took 52.79 and 102.36 seconds respectively, in the Best mode.

Though the Epson was clearly the fastest printer, we wanted to make sure it also offered quality. The Brother won the text fight, followed closely by Samsung. Epson while Canon tied for third place.

Canon, again, was the best in terms of colour differentiation and got the difference between the colour bars the best. All the others just stumbled through this test scoring

roughly the same, except for the Brother, which did such a bad job that the photo was totally blurred.

In terms of results, what the above translates into is, if your office work basically comprises text documents and you don't need large photographs to be printed, it is advisable to opt for the Brother, but then, don't expect photo quality performance.

On the other hand, if you feel that you will need to print photographs or brochures (even rough drafts), you should definitely consider the Epson, as it offers far better performance.

In High Quality mode, Epson did a lot better than the rest and secured first place. Canon was close behind and finished the race only slightly behind. The Brother did rather badly, and came in last behind the Samsung CLP500.

We then obviously checked the photo printing capabilities of these printers and once again, Epson raced ahead to take the top spot beating Canon and Samsung to third and fourth places respectively.

For the Brother, we found that the skin shade looked yellowish. A similar problem was noticeable for contrast, where colours were smudged.

As we mentioned, if you are going to print photographs or graphics, stick to Epson.

We noticed that Samsung provided a 3-year on-site in warranty, while Canon gives